

Market Intel — Monday, 2026-05-18

Cross-asset intelligence · generated 2026-05-18T16:39:55Z

Confidence: *med*

RISK-OFF

Tech leading downside (-2.84% w1), crypto broadly red (-2-4% d1), funding deeply negative across BTC/ETH/XRP (-0.82% to -14.94% APR), DeFi capital bleeding \$5.56B CEX outflow 24h, F&G 28 (Fear). Macro confirmation unavailable. [Yahoo Finance · XLK (Technology)] [CoinGecko Simple Price] [Bybit Linear Perpetuals (mark, OI, funding)] [DefiLlama Categories (sector rotation)] [alternative.me · Crypto Fear & Greed]

1. Macro Drivers

- SPY -0.48% d1, -0.50% w1 amid tech weakness; XLK -1.95% d1, -2.84% w1 leads downside. [1] [2]
- VIX 18.41 elevated but below crisis levels. Implied volatility steady, risk-off but orderly. [3]
- [MISSING CITATION] Macro data (10y/2y rates, USD index, CPI, PCE, NFP, HY OAS, Fed Funds) unavailable—FRED API key not configured.

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not available this run: US 2y yield (FRED DGS2)

not available this run: DXY USD index (FRED DTWEXBGS)

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not available this run: PCE inflation (FRED PCEPI)

not available this run: Nonfarm Payrolls (FRED PAYEMS)

not available this run: HY OAS (FRED BAMLH0A0HYM2)

not available this run: Fed Funds Rate (FRED DFF)

2. Equity Sector Rotation

- Tech weakness (-2.84% w1, -8.38% vs SPY m1) vs defensive hold: Staples +2.43% w1, Comms +1.37% w1. [4] [5] [6]
- Energy resilience: XLE +6.03% w1, +10.18% m1 (outperforming +6.59% vs SPY). Commodity bid intact. [7]
- Healthcare stable (+1.51% w1), Real Estate +0.86% d1. Defensive tilt confirmed. [8] [9]

3. Cross-Asset Flows

- SPY -0.48% d1, Gold -0.33%, WTI -1.96% d1. Equity weakness not fully risk-off; energy commodity bid intact. [10] [11] [12]
- VIX 18.41, Put/Call 0.93 (<1.0 bullish). Market structure not panicking despite equity weakness. [13] [14]
- BTC dominance 58.19%, ETH dominance 9.64% stable despite price declines. Capital preservation within crypto. [15]

4. Crypto Market Structure

- BTC \$76,391 (-2.18% d1), dominance 58.19% stable. Funding -0.82% APR (neutral, not extreme). [16] [17]
- ETH \$2,095.77 (-4.09% d1), ETH/BTC 0.02743. Funding -5.93% APR signals longs exiting or shorts covering. [18] [19]
- XRP \$1.38 (-2.78% d1), funding -14.94% APR (extreme negative). Shorts pile in despite price weakness. [20] [21]
- SOL \$84.25 (-2.65% d1), funding -0.89% APR. Ecosystem resilient; OI \$600M supports strength narrative. [22] [23]
- SUI \$1.036 (-2.96% d1), funding +2.28% APR (only positive carry). Longs accumulating or shorts reducing. [24] [25]

- Stablecoins USDT \$189.7B, USDC \$77B, total \$321.7B. Supply stable, no fiat flight visible. [26]

5. Sentiment & Positioning

- Fear & Greed index 28 (Fear)—below neutral but not capitulation (<20). Market temperament subdued, not panicked. [27]
- Put/Call 0.93 (<1.0 bullish). Options positioning shows slight bullish bias, not extreme either direction. [28]
- VIX 18.41 elevated but orderly. Implied equity volatility steady, no panic signal. [29]

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6. Seasonality

- SPY ISO week 21 (10-year): mean +0.5%, positive 60%, median +0.18%. Bullish seasonal bias into late May. [30]
- BTC ISO week 21 (10-year): mean +0.14%, positive 50%, median +0.19%. Weaker seasonal bid than equities. [31]

Lookback: 10y · Sample size: n=10

7. Trending Narratives

- AI infrastructure capex race (Nvidia 5/20 earnings, AMD server share gains). Profit-taking before print is normal. [32]
- Real-world asset tokenization (JPMorgan filing, Ondo, BlackRock). RWA TVL \$27.1B resilient -0.61% w1 vs DeFi bleed. [33] [34]
- Stablecoin regulation (Clarity Act in Senate final stage as of 5/14). USDT \$189.7B, USDC \$77B dominant. [35] [36]
- Bitcoin ETF consolidation (BlackRock \$172M shift to Coinbase custody). No net outflow signal; internal move only. [37]

8. What to Watch Next

not available this run: ForexFactory macro calendar returned empty (no high-impact USD events detected in next 14d)

9. Crypto Sector & Chain Rotation

- CEX TVL \$273.8B (51% of DeFi) hemorrhaging \$5.56B in 24h. Leveraged traders exiting; deleveraging cascade. [38]
- Liquid Staking -\$1.29B 24h (-10.3% w1). Stakers exiting post-Shanghai uncertainty; OG yield thesis cooling. [39]
- Layer-2 collapse: Base -9.47% d1, Arbitrum -27.68% m1. Capital rotating to Ethereum L1 (52.66% dominance stable). [40]
- Solana +0.42% w1 vs market down. High-speed L1 capturing capital; ecosystem strength holds despite macro headwinds. [41]
- Canonical Bridge anomaly: +21.46% d1 despite ecosystem-wide outflows. Potential protocol-specific governance or release event. [42]

not available this run: Whale-level on-chain attribution requires Glassnode/Whale Alert paid tier (not available)

Sources

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[40] **DefiLlama · Top Chains by TVL** — 2026-05-18T16:39:59Z

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[41] **DefiLlama · Top Chains by TVL** — 2026-05-18T16:39:59Z

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Fetcher	Source	Age	OK	Note
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yf_XLF	Yahoo Finance · XLF (Financials)	0.0h	✓	
yf_XLE	Yahoo Finance · XLE (Energy)	-0.0h	✓	
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nasdaq_earnings	Nasdaq Earnings Calendar	-0.02h	✓	
sec_8k	SEC EDGAR · Recent 8-K Filings	-0.03h	✓	
cmc_calendar	CoinMarketCal Events	-0.03h	✗	403 Client Error: Forbidden for url: ht...

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